

The Ferdinand Times

VOL. 1 — THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 24, 2026 — MEXICO CITY — AS OF 5:54 A.M.

YOUR DAY

Billing reminder ages past due; Codex keeps reviewing audiogram PRs

Hetzner asked for payment by yesterday. Three pull requests on audiogram-inbox still have bot review notes. Evening work blocks are unchanged.



Ferdinand, Hetzner sent a payment warning earlier this week that asked for open invoices to be settled by September 23. The message is still in the inbox, and it says services can lock if the balance stays open. Separately, Codex left fresh review comments on audiogram-inbox pull requests, including the question-driven analysis contract on PR #9, after earlier notes on transcript persistence and clip rendering.

Telmex also mailed a speed bump notice (850 to 1000 megas, same plan terms). Looking ahead, Redpanda's Streamhouse session is listed for Tuesday evening, and the calendar still has Checkpoint day on Tuesday night after the usual Discovery block.

TODAY

6:00 A.M.	News / catchup Hacker Rank, TLDR, Product Hunt	RITUAL
6:30 A.M.	Swim	2 HR
10:15 A.M.	Food	30 MIN
3:00 P.M.	Food	30 MIN
4:00 P.M.	Miami	BLOCK
6:30 P.M.	Discovery	BLOCK
10:00 P.M.	Journaling Reflection prompts in the event notes	1 HR

THIS WEEK

FRI-MON PATTERN — Swim → Miami → Discovery → Journaling. Same weekday skeleton as today.
TUE SEP 29 — Streamhouse (Redpanda). Live session on AI agents and streaming; invite arrived Wed.
TUE SEP 30 — Checkpoint day. On the calendar after Discovery; personal checklist only.

WEATHER

25–26° / 14–15° HIGH / LOW

Partly cloudy to overcast through the afternoon, with a high near 25–26°C and a morning low around 14–15°C. Light showers are possible after sunset; winds stay light. Sunrise 6:25 a.m., sunset 6:31 p.m.



FRI	Overcast	~26 / ~14
SAT	Thunderstorm risk	~25 / ~14
SUN	Overcast	~26 / ~14
MON	Overcast	~27 / ~16

NEEDS A LOOK

HETZNER BILLING **ACTION**
Payment warning still open. Asked for open invoices by Sep 23; warns services may lock if unpaid.

GITHUB / CODEX **ACTION**
audiogram-inbox PR #9 review notes. Question-driven analysis contract; regression assertions on answer schemas.

GITHUB / CODEX **FYI**
audiogram-inbox PR #7 and #8 notes. Transcript persistence, clip rendering, and related review comments.

VERCEL **FYI**
New sign-in detected. Sign-in from Mexico City area Wed afternoon.

REDPANDA EVENTS **FYI**
Streamhouse live session. Tue Sep 29; AI agents and streaming theme.

TELMEX **FYI**
Speed increase notice. Plan speed raised; no action required beyond reading.

TONIGHT

Discovery block 6:30–10:00 p.m.; Journaling at 10:00 p.m.

DUE

Hetzner payment warning (deadline was Wed Sep 23).

INBOX

TLDR

Meta VR headset, Anthropic finds enzyme, code ownership

FROM TLDR

Meta has launched the Meta VR Glasses. The device has many of the same features as Meta's existing Quest headsets. Its processor, cooling fan, battery, and other computing components are housed in an external pack. At about 100 grams, the device is roughly one-sixth the weight of Apple's Vision Pro.

Claude autonomously discovered a novel enzyme system that is associated with an array of DNA repeats. The system's function is still unknown, but it is programmable and can perform operations like cutting, copying, and pasting DNA.

It is based on a reverse transcriptase previously known to science, but Claude appears to be the first to notice the system's defining features - an associated array of non-coding DNA sequences and an additional accessory protein of unknown function.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: TLDR goes on to report a favorable FDA panel vote for Grail's multi-cancer blood test, China's Supercomputing-1 satellite for on-orbit Earth-observation processing, and a longer essay arguing that agent coding redistributes code ownership beyond engineers. A separate Anthropic post says claude.ai load times dropped sharply in a two-week sprint. Quick links mention ChatGPT-in-Siri underperformance, Meta's palm-sized Muse Charm gadget, and YouTube's promised custom feeds.

BYTEBYTEGO

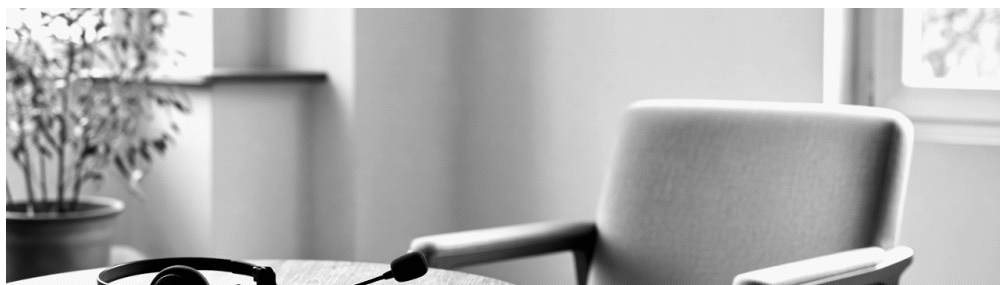
How OpenAI Built GPT-Live

FROM BYTEBYTEGO

If you have used voice assistants before, you have probably experienced unexpected interruptions. You talk with the system, and the moment you pause briefly to think of the right term, it starts talking. Then you interrupt it so you can continue. This is a common frustration, because most voice models can either listen or speak, but not both at the same time.

Newer voice models, like OpenAI's GPT-Live-1, change that by listening and speaking at the same time. The model constantly decides whether it should stay quiet, interrupt, or start talking. This makes the conversation feel more natural with fewer unintentional interruptions.

Under the hood, these systems combine a new generation of voice model architecture with a serving system optimized for low latency. To understand how it all works end to end, we met with engineers on the GPT Voice team, Zahan Malkani and Justin Uberti (who created WebRTC). We thank both of them for sharing the details with us.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: ByteByteGo then describes three generations of voice systems—cascaded ASR/LLM/TTS, turn-based speech-to-speech, and full-duplex models that emit silent tokens when they should stay quiet. GPT-Live keeps a small voice model on a hard real-time “live path,” delegates harder reasoning to a frontier model on an async path, and uses tricks such as one-round-trip session setup, sticky GPU sessions, and managed handoffs. Evaluation shifts from turn scoring to conversational timing, stream health at extreme tail latency, and silent launches on real traffic.

[blog.bytebytego.com / how-openai-built-gpt-live](https://blog.bytebytego.com/how-openai-built-gpt-live)

INBOX

EVERY

How to Get the Most Out of Jev

BY LAURA ENTIS



Jev is fast, cheap, and accurate enough to handle the judgment calls you'd never pay an LLM to make at scale—is this email urgent, does this paragraph sound like AI, should I escalate this customer service request—on everything, all the time. Today, head of evals Mike Taylor explains what that unlocks, head of marketing Douglas Brundage shares his shortcut for putting Jev to work, and senior editor Jack Cheng shows why Jev is so good at turning intent into action.

What happened: On September 15, Type-Safe, an AI frontier lab that spent two years in stealth, released Jev, a model that classifies text and structured data instead of generating it. The release lit a match that has yet to sputter: On X, Jev demos are everywhere. Users have gone viral showcasing how Jev can be used to play video games, re-rank search results, and filter social media posts, among so many other uses. Senior editor Jack Cheng's Jev demo, which shows the model's ability to infer a user's intent from speech and hand gestures, has surpassed 1 million views.

Once you get your head around what Jev is and isn't—a decision model, not a chatbot—the fascination makes sense. Frame a task as a yes-or-no question, a multiple-choice pick, or a rating in plain English, and Jev returns a probability. Because it outputs probabilities rather than generating text one token at a time, Jev can answer huge batches of questions in parallel, almost instantly, and for a fraction of the cost of text-based LLMs.

EDITOR'S SUMMARY: Entis goes on to explain Mike Taylor's rule of thumb: if a human could finish the judgment in under about ten seconds, Jev is a fit; longer reasoning still belongs to a language model. Subjective asks such as "is this urgent?" work better when broken into clearer checks, then combined in code. The issue also walks through installing TypeSafe's skill, turning fuzzy intent into discrete Jev questions, and using Jev beside agents for guardrails and inbox triage.

THE PRAGMATIC ENGINEER

How will AI change operating systems? Part 2: Windows

FROM THE PRAGMATIC ENGINEER

AI is changing how us software engineers build software, and developers' tool preferences are rapidly evolving with it – like how AI coding harnesses have gotten very popular. Likewise, future versions of the world's leading operating systems look certain to feature more support for agentic tools.

To find out how things are changing, we talked with the folks at tech giant Microsoft who shared in detail their plan for Windows, and how AI will play a part. It comes after the company's previous AI efforts led to it being dubbed "Microslop" by some users online.

The Windows team's vision is opinionated and includes building new agentic primitives, alongside reversing some decisions that have annoyed engineers. Microsoft wants developers who have shunned the system to return. The big question is: will it succeed?

EDITOR'S SUMMARY: The deepdive then covers developer OS share surveys, Entra-based agent identities, an on-device MCP registry, Microsoft Execution Containers for tool isolation, Windows ML for local inference across GPU/NPU/CPU, embedded small models, WSL, and ARM hardware plans. Interviews include Pavan Davuluri, Scott Hanselman, and Logan Iyer. The through-line is making Windows a safer place to run agents while cleaning up Start-menu and search clutter that drove engineers away.

newsletter@pragmaticengineer.com / windows-and-ai

THE TOWN

RECOMMENDED

American Hostage – MGM+

Jon Hamm plays Indianapolis radio news director Fred Heckman in a 1977 true-crime series that starts when a used-car salesman wires a shotgun to a mortgage broker's neck and demands live airtime. Only the first two episodes are out so far; the show is already near the top of MGM+'s chart and sitting around 90% on early Rotten Tomatoes scores. New episodes arrive Sundays.

Beck – Ride Lonesome

Beck's first album in seven years returns to the quiet folk-rock lane of Sea Change and Morning Phase, written after his divorce. Reviews call out spare slide guitar, orchestral tracks, and a long centerpiece, "Bleed," mixed with help from Nigel Godrich. It is a headphones record more than a party record.

ON THE TOWN

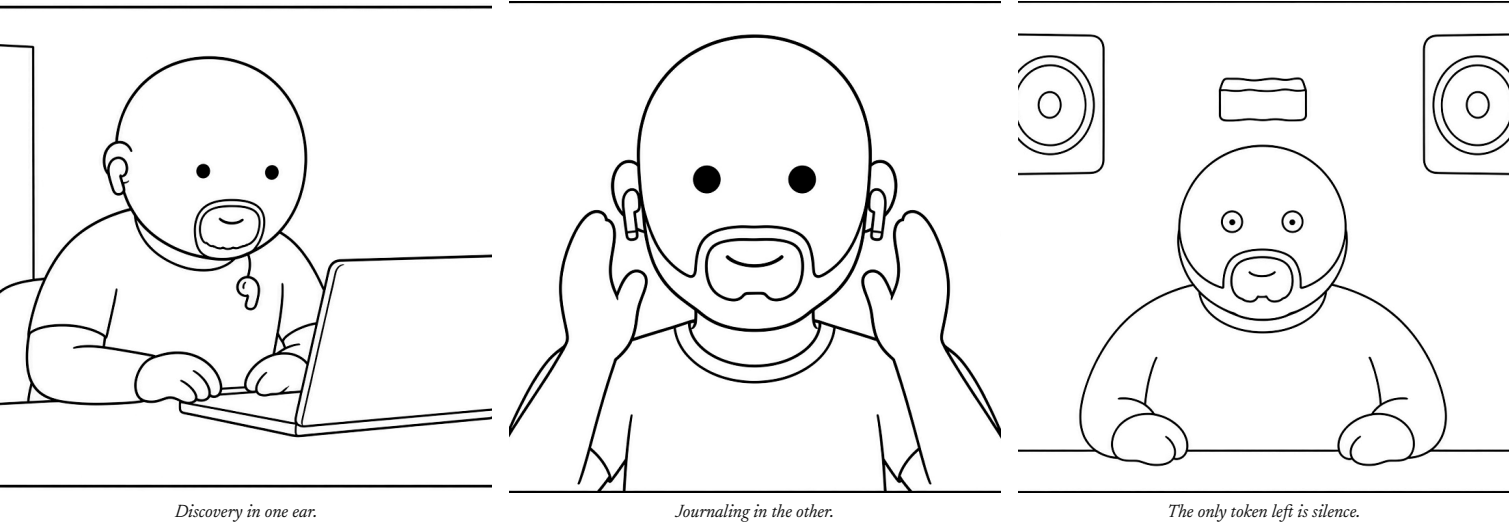
Chicharras – tonight, CCU

Luna Marán's 2024 documentary follows women in San Pablo Begú as a community decision about a future project unfolds. Filmoteca UNAM screens it tonight at Sala Carlos Monsiváis in Centro Cultural Universitario, Coyoacán, with an introduction and Q&A with Marán afterward. Free entry; limited seats.

Danzón – tonight, CCU

María Novaro's 1991 film follows a Mexico City telefonista who leaves for Veracruz after her dance partner disappears from the salon. Cineclub Enfoques Libres shows it at Sala José Revueltas, also at CCU, with Novaro present for a pre-show talk and debate after. Free entry; limited seats. Starts mid-afternoon, before the Chicharras slot.

PUZZLES



MINI CROSSWORD

1	2	3	4	5
6				
7				
8				
9				

- ACROSS**
- 1 Change between Telmex's old and new megas – or any difference that shows up as a number
- 6 What Hetzner, Codex, and Redpanda all delivered into this morning's phone check
- 7 Not the small language model – Windows ML's hardware story aims for __ coverage
- 8 Big cat; also the energy of a payment warning that wants you awake
- 9 What that Hetzner subject line is built to produce
- DOWN**
- 1 Same as 1-Across (word-square twin)
- 2 Same as 6-Across
- 3 Same as 7-Across
- 4 Same as 8-Across
- 5 Same as 9-Across

DELTA · EMAIL · LARGE · TIGER · ALERT

DEAR TIMES

Do I stop Discovery for a billing lock threat?

Dear Times, Hetzner mailed a payment warning that named yesterday as the pay-by date and mentioned locking services if invoices stay open. Swim and Miami still ran as usual. Discovery is on the calendar again tonight. Do I break the evening block to deal with billing first, or finish Discovery and handle it after journaling?

– Invoice Adjacent in Mexico City

Dear Invoice Adjacent, Handle the billing before Discovery. A lock warning with a date already in the past is the one item that can erase tomorrow's tools; the evening block can move. Open the invoice, clear what is owed, then return to Discovery with one less tab pulsing.

– The Times

JUMBLE
Unscramble each word. Circled answer boxes spell the bonus. What GPT-Live keeps fast while thinking runs elsewhere (4 letters).

YXPRO
○□□□□

TADAP
○□□□□

RETAL
□□○□□

DLOHS
○□□□□

PROXY ADAPT LATER HOLDS · PATH

WANTED Full-duplex evening referee Must decide which earbud speaks when Discovery and Journaling overlap. Silent tokens preferred; turn detectors need not apply. Human merge authority for agent-reviewed PRs Must read Codex notes on audiogram-inbox without opening a fourth diff viewer. Stamp optional; judgment mandatory.	FOR SALE Slightly past-due sense of urgency Originally issued by a German cloud host. Still functional; pairs well with a calendar that did not clear space for it. Buyer assumes inbox ownership. One unused Telmex celebration emoji pack Generated by a speed-bump marketing letter. Does not increase upload. Transfers as FYI only.	NOTICES Municipal singular Light evening showers possible after a mild afternoon high near the mid-20s. Carry a light shell if Discovery spills outdoors. This is weather, not an appointment. Department of Classification Jev-style decision models may sort mail into urgent and not. Citizens are advised that a swimming goggle is not a priority inbox item, even if stamped.
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